

Brother Money - Naming System + Microcopy System

1. Naming Philosophy

Brother Money language is designed to describe reality, not financial systems.

We avoid technical, accounting, or fintech terminology.

We use simple, human, action-based language that reduces thinking.

2. Core Vocabulary System

All product language belongs to four categories:

Reality (what exists)

- Cash
- Money now
- Today

Protection (what is reserved)

- Protected
- Set aside
- Needed

Freedom (what is usable)

- Safe to spend
- Available
- Good to use

Risk (what is missing)

- Behind
 - Short
 - Not enough
 - Needs more
-

3. Naming Conventions

Avoid

- Budget
- Expense
- Category
- Allocation
- Forecast
- Balance
- Ledger
- Liabilities

Use instead

- Cash Now
 - Safe Spend
 - Protected Money
 - Money Left
 - What you can use
 - What's coming up
-

4. Core Feature Naming

Home Screen

Avoid:

- Dashboard

Use:

- Today
-

Safe Spend

Avoid:

- Available Balance
- Spending Power

Use:

- Safe to Spend Today
 - Safe to Spend
-

Cash Input

Avoid:

- Add Transaction
- Reconcile

Use:

- Update My Cash
-

Purchase Feature

Avoid:

- Budget Check
- Expense Simulation

Use:

- Can I Buy This?
-

Bills

Use:

- Bills

(Keep simple and human)

Savings

Use:

- Savings or

- Money to Save
-

Emergency Buffer

Use:

- Emergency Money or
 - Do Not Touch
-

5. Microcopy System

All UI text must be:

- short
 - direct
 - emotionally calm
 - decision-oriented
-

6. Home Screen Microcopy

SAFE

- You're good today.
 - You can safely spend \$42.
 - Everything important is covered.
-

CAUTION

- You have a small buffer today.
 - Try to keep spending light.
 - Safe to spend: \$12
-

RISK

- You're behind on commitments.
- Focus on essentials only.
- Safe to spend: -\$18

7. Explanation Rules

- Always 1 sentence
 - No financial jargon
 - No analytical explanations
-

Example

Avoid:

- “Based on your budget allocation and liabilities...”

Use:

- “Rent and savings need to be protected soon.”
-

8. Can I Buy This Flow

Input

- What do you want to buy?
 - How much does it cost?
-

Results

YES

- You can buy this.
 - You'll still be okay after.
-

WAIT

- Not yet.
 - You need \$12 more to make this safe.
-

● NO

- This would affect your essentials.
 - Better to wait.
-

9. Income Awareness Language

Avoid:

- Forecast
- Projection
- Cash flow model

Use:

- Your salary is expected before rent is due.
 - After payday, you'll be fine.
 - This income is not guaranteed.
-

10. Error / System Messages

Avoid:

- Error
- Invalid
- Failed

Use:

- We need an updated cash amount.
 - Your money might be outdated.
 - Update your cash for accurate guidance.
-

11. Empty States

- Just update your cash to get started.
 - Add your bills so we can protect them.
 - Set a simple savings goal.
-

12. Time Language

Avoid:

- Monthly reports
- Financial periods

Use:

- Today
 - This week
 - Next payday
 - Soon
-

13. Emotional Tone System

Calm Neutral

- You can spend \$20 today.

Gentle Warning

- Keep spending light today.

Firm Constraint

- Focus on essentials only.
-

14. Button Language

Allowed verbs

- Update
- Check
- Buy
- Add
- Review

Examples

- Update Cash

- Can I Buy This?
- Check Today
- Add Bill

Avoid:

- Submit
 - Continue
 - Confirm
-

15. Signature Style

Brother Money language is:

- short
- declarative
- emotionally neutral
- consistent

Example:

- Safe to spend: \$42

Not:

- “Based on your financial position, you may allocate...”
-

16. Brand Voice Summary

Brother Money speaks like:

A calm sibling who tells you the truth in one sentence.

17. System Definition

Every sentence in Brother Money does one of three things:

- tells you what is safe
- tells you what is protected
- tells you what is missing

Nothing else.